$(n+1)$-st Homework Assignment

Due Date: The day of the final exam meeting period.

This is your final assignment for CSCI 432.

Write a two-page paper describing to me how you have grown as a student, computer scientist, mathematician, engineer, or a researcher in this class, and more generally, in this semester. To support your argument, you should include your homework or writing samples (or excerpts from them) in an appendix as evidence (and reference them!). In particular, be sure to look back at your answers to the questions in Homework 0.

If you do not feel that you've grown, explain why.

Remember, style counts. Use complete sentences.

Over the course of this semester I have grown a lot as a student. This class has taught me so much about how to be a successful learner. My learning process has improved thanks to the workload from this course. I was able to keep myself accountable for my own development outside of the classroom whether it was completing handouts I couldn't finish in class, or preparing for class with assigned readings. I also improved my study habits and general test taking attitude, and I would like to think that showed in my quiz and exam grades.

I have grown exponentially as a researcher this semester as well. A large contributing factor to this was the group final projects we did towards the end of the semester. Knowing that I would have to teach the class made the research that much more important, not only to make the presentation accurate, but to give an informative lecture for my fellow classmates. I also researched all of the possible topics a good bit to find the ones that interested me the most, which got me very excited to start working on the project.

The improvements I have made as a computer scientist this semester honestly surprised me. Not just because of new knowledge gained but also due to the improvement of my comp sci foundation coming into this class. I came into this class with a pretty good understanding of discrete structures, data structures, and writing proofs, but my eyes were opened to improvements I could make. One of these was being able to be given an algorithm and break it down step by step until I can understand what it's doing, as well as being able to prove it works. Induction was definitely a weak point for me coming into this class but I can confidently say that not only do I understand it, but I can use it to help make sense of recursive algorithms as well as loop invariant proofs.

As far as how I feel going into my senior year, it's safe to say that I absolutely feel prepared for what's to come. This semester has done so much for me in getting me ready for my final year of working towards my computer science degree. Whether its as a student, researcher, or computer scientist the steps I have taken to grow in each of these aspects of my education have no doubt have made me stronger. I really enjoyed this course and thank you for everything you've taught me not just about algorithms but also myself as a student.